

4.4 The Three-Scene Stress Test

4.4.1 Action Plan

1. Open your AI tool. Paste your completed Dialogue Matrix into the system prompt or character instruction field.
2. Generate Scene One (Conflict). Read the output. Set it aside.
3. Generate Scene Two (Flirtation). Read the output. Set it aside.
4. Generate Scene Three (Vulnerability). Read the output. Set it aside.
5. Run the Ninety-Second Voice Verification Read (from Chapter 2) on each scene. Log your results.
6. Identify any drifting fields. Adjust one field at a time. Regenerate. Reverify.
7. Repeat until all three scenes hold. Confirm by reading all three back-to-back.

4.4.2 AI Prompt Templates for the Three Test Scenes

AI Prompt Template: Conflict Scene Test

Using the following Dialogue Matrix, write 4–6 lines of dialogue for [CHARACTER_NAME] in this scene:

[CHARACTER_NAME] is in a heated argument with [LOVE_INTEREST_NAME]. The love interest has just said something that strikes [CHARACTER_NAME]'s core wound: [NAME_THE_WOUND, e.g., "the belief that their needs are an inconvenience"]. The temperature is high. The stakes are personal. Show [CHARACTER_NAME] responding in character, using the speech patterns defined in the matrix.

[PASTE_YOUR_FULL_DIALOGUE_MATRIX_HERE]

AI Prompt Template: Flirtation Scene Test

Using the following Dialogue Matrix, write 4–6 lines of dialogue for [CHARACTER_NAME] in this scene:

[CHARACTER_NAME] is in a moment of charged attraction with [LOVE_INTEREST_NAME]. The love interest is teasing or gently provoking them. [CHARACTER_NAME] is trying to maintain composure while clearly affected. Show the mask working overtime—controlled on the surface, charged underneath.

[PASTE_YOUR_FULL_DIALOGUE_MATRIX_HERE]

AI Prompt Template: Vulnerability Scene Test

Using the following Dialogue Matrix, write 4–6 lines of dialogue for [CHARACTER_NAME] in this scene:

[CHARACTER_NAME]'s defenses have fully cracked. They are saying something they have never said aloud to [LOVE_INTEREST_NAME]. The room is quiet. The words cost everything. Show the contradiction from Layer Seven emerging—the mask failing, the raw voice underneath slipping through.

[PASTE_YOUR_FULL_DIALOGUE_MATRIX_HERE]

4.4.3 Three-Scene Verification Log

Character: [CHARACTER_NAME]

Matrix Version: [V1.0 / V1.1 / ETC.]

Date: [DATE]

Dimension	Conflict Scene	Flirtation Scene	Vulnerability Scene
Cadence	[Holds / Drifts]	[Holds / Drifts]	[Holds / Drifts]
Vocabulary	[Holds / Drifts]	[Holds / Drifts]	[Holds / Drifts]
Sentence Variance	[Holds / Drifts]	[Holds / Drifts]	[Holds / Drifts]
Emotional Register	[Holds / Drifts]	[Holds / Drifts]	[Holds / Drifts]
Conversational Rhythm	[Holds / Drifts]	[Holds / Drifts]	[Holds / Drifts]

Overall Result:

- ☐ All fifteen cells read "Holds" → Matrix is complete. Save and deploy.
- ☐ One to three cells read "Drifts" → Identify the failing field. Adjust. Regenerate. Reverify.
- ☐ More than three cells read "Drifts" → Return to the matrix. Two or more fields are underspecified.

4.4.4 Decision Tree: Diagnosing a Drifting Scene

Step 1 – Which scene drifted?

- Conflict → Proceed to Step 2a.

- Flirtation → Proceed to Step 2b.
- Vulnerability → Proceed to Step 2c.

Step 2a – Conflict scene drift:

Symptom	Failing Field	Fix
Generic anger, shouting, name-calling	Emotional Default	Add a wound-specific trigger-response clause
Too calm, too measured, no heat	Sentence Architecture	Add: "Under conflict: reduce sentence length by 50%. Increase fragments."
Vocabulary shifts to formal or academic	Vocabulary Ceiling	Add: "Under conflict: maintain default register. Do not shift to formal distancing."

Step 2b – Flirtation scene drift:

Symptom	Failing Field	Fix
Too smooth, too charming, no tension	Conversational Rhythm	Add: "Under attraction: turn-taking loosens. Sentences trail. Pauses lengthen."
Identical to baseline, no shift at all	Emotional Default	Increase the leakage rate for attraction contexts
Overly verbal, too many words	Cadence Signature	Add: "Under attraction: sentences lengthen by 20%. Pauses become loaded."

Step 2c – Vulnerability scene drift:

Symptom	Failing Field	Fix
Sentimental, overwrought, melodramatic	Cadence Signature	Add: "When defenses crack: revert to two-to four-word fragments. Trail off. Leave thoughts incomplete."
Identical to baseline, no crack visible	Signature Tics or Emotional Default	Reference the Layer Seven inversion explicitly
Too articulate, too composed	Vocabulary Ceiling	Add: "Under vulnerability: drop to simplest available words. No polysyllabic distancing."

4.4.5 Overconstraining Self-Assessment

Read your three test scenes back-to-back and answer each question. Your matrix should produce a recognizable voice that modulates with emotion, like a single instrument playing

different dynamics.

- ☐ Can I hear the same character in all three scenes? (The timbre holds.)
- ☐ Does the voice shift noticeably between scenes? (The dynamics change.)
- ☐ Is the conflict scene measurably different in rhythm or vocabulary from the flirtation scene? (The instrument responds to the music.)
- ☐ Does the vulnerability scene feel like the same person with their armor removed, rather than a different person entirely? (The mask cracks; the human underneath is recognizable.)
- ☐ If I removed the scene labels, could I still tell which scene was which based on the speech patterns alone? (The modulation is audible.)

When all five boxes are checked, your matrix is balanced. If any box fails, find the field that feels the most rigid, loosen one constraint in that field, then regenerate and reread.